

Weight Management



Why is weight management important?

Being overweight increases your risk of having a heart attack or stroke. Use the table on the next page to see if you are a healthy weight. If you are overweight, small amounts of weight loss (5–10 percent of your weight) will have major health benefits including:

- ♥ Lowering your blood pressure
- ♥ Improving energy levels
- ♥ Improving your blood glucose (sugar) control
- ♥ Lowering your risk of having a heart attack or stroke.
- ♥ Improving sleep patterns
- ♥ Improving your blood cholesterol levels

How do I lose weight

Avoid crash or fad diets. Set a realistic goal – aim to reduce your weight by ½kg–2kgs (1–4½lbs) per month. It might not sound much, but slow changes make it easier to keep the weight off. Learning healthy eating habits takes time and will benefit your immediate and long-term wellness.

Try to do at least 30–60 minutes of moderate activity every day of the week.

Remember, any physical activity is better than none!

- ♥ Try eating a little less – use a smaller plate, take time to enjoy your meal and eat enough to feel satisfied rather than full
- ♥ Eat more vegetables and fruit in place of other foods – make half your plate colourful vegetables (e.g. carrots, spinach)
- ♥ Eat less fatty foods – especially butter, deep fried foods, fatty meats, chicken skin, coconut cream, pastries and bakery items
- ♥ Eat less sugary foods – especially sugary drinks, sweets, desserts and bakery items
- ♥ Choose wholegrain and high fibre cereals or breads – they help you feel satisfied for longer.

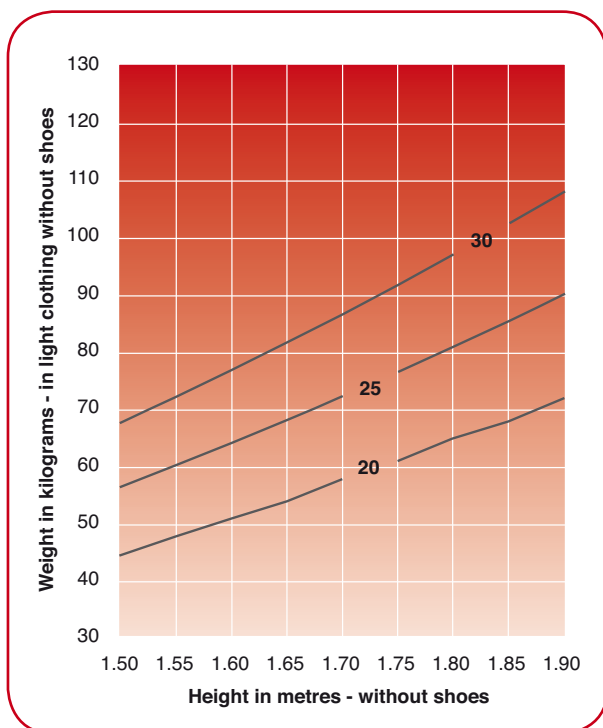
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Am I a healthy weight?

Find your height on the bottom of the chart. Go straight up from that point until you reach the line that intersects with your weight – that point is your Body Mass Index (BMI). Use that point to identify your body weight status using the table below. If your weight doesn't show up on this table, see your doctor/nurse.

Table of Body Mass Index (BMI)



Underweight	Healthy	Overweight	Obese
Less than 20	20 to 25	25 to 30	Greater than 30

Waist circumference should be less than 90cm (36 inches) for women and less than 100cm (39 inches) for men. Measure from the point half way between your lowest rib and your hip bone.

If you are having trouble losing weight or you are gaining weight over time, talk to your doctor, nurse, dietitian or health professional.